

User Feedback / Formative Evaluation 1

1 Session overview

Project stage: Mid-development prototype

Session date: 2026-4-10

Duration: Approximately 30 minutes

Participant: 1 user from our intended target group

Method: Guided walkthrough + think-aloud feedback during task exploration

2 Participant profile

The participant was a potential target user of our system and had basic experience with using web applications and repository-related tools. The participant was not deeply familiar with our project beforehand, which made the session useful for identifying clarity and usability issues from a fresh-user perspective.

3 Goal of the session

The purpose of this session was to evaluate:

- whether the main structure of the application is understandable,
- whether repository-related workflows are clear,
- whether the dashboard and supporting pages communicate system status effectively,
- and which parts of the interface still need improvement before the final version.

4 Tasks / walkthrough focus

During the session, the participant explored the prototype and commented on the following core parts of the system:

- navigation and overall layout,
- repository selection and synchronization,
- dashboard interaction,
- notifications,
- request creation,
- ranking and leaderboard,
- quest configuration.

5 Main feedback from the participant

The participant felt that the application already had a usable base, but several interaction and layout decisions were still confusing or disruptive.

6 Detailed feedback points

- Pop-up content should be separated from the main display area, because rendering it directly inside the page causes layout shifts and makes the interface feel unstable.
- A dropdown list of personal repositories should be added in the workspace area or the left sidebar, so users can switch repositories more easily and refresh the current page automatically.
- The notifications page should not be inserted directly into the main page content. A modal or a right-side drawer would work better.
- Manual synchronization with the remote repository does not currently work.
- On the dashboard page, the “Sync to load GitHub data” button is unclear, and the user could not tell whether it actually worked.
- The dashboard layout is not properly aligned between the left and right sections.
- If retry fails, the system should provide a clearer and more visible error message, preferably as a modal or strong notification.
- After creating a request, the three displayed attributes are unclear, and the creation flow itself needs to be refined.
- In the ranking system, the experience point values should ideally be editable so users can customize them.
- On the leaderboard page, clearer date labels should be shown for “This Week” and “All Time.”
- In the Quest Configurator, it is still unclear whether the settings should apply globally or per repository, and the current input fields need more careful design.

7 Observed usability problems

From this session, we identified four main usability issues:

1. Layout instability

Some interactive elements are currently rendered inside the main content area, which causes the page to shift and reduces perceived stability.

2. Unclear repository workflow

The participant was unsure how repository switching, syncing, and refresh behavior worked. This shows that the system does not yet communicate repository context clearly enough.

3. Weak system feedback

Some actions, especially sync and retry, do not provide strong enough feedback. Users may not understand whether an action succeeded, failed, or is still in progress.

4. Low clarity in configurable features

Parts of the system such as request attributes, ranking settings, and quest configuration are not yet self-explanatory and need better wording, structure, or scope definition.

8 Planned improvements after this feedback

Based on the session, we plan to implement the following changes:

- Move notifications and dialog-like interactions out of the main page content and use modals or side drawers instead.
- Add a repository dropdown in the sidebar or workspace area for faster switching.
- Refresh the current page automatically after repository selection.
- Fix the manual sync feature.
- Clarify the purpose and state of the dashboard sync button.
- Improve dashboard alignment and visual consistency.
- Show clearer retry failure messages.
- Redesign or explain the request creation result fields more clearly.
- Allow customizable experience point settings in the ranking system.
- Add explicit date ranges to leaderboard labels.
- Reconsider whether Quest Configurator should be repository-specific.

9 Reflection

This feedback session was valuable because it showed that the main idea of the application is understandable, but several workflows are still not transparent enough for first-time users. The participant's comments helped us identify specific interaction issues that were easy to overlook during implementation. We will use this feedback to improve clarity, reduce layout disruption, and make important actions more understandable and controllable.

10 Screenshots of Adopted Changes



